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2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

HOUSE CONCURRENT
RESOLUTION 1026

By: Hefner and Archer of the
House

and

Nice of the Senate

AS INTRODUCED

A Concurrent Resolution recognizing light pollution's impact on bird mortality, particularly during migration; encouraging Oklahoma businesses, state agencies, universities and schools, sports complexes, organizations, and residents to turn off any exterior lighting and shield interior lighting from shining outside during the high migration intensity months of April, May, September, and October.

WHEREAS, the State of Oklahoma and the Oklahoma Animal Coalition aim to provide birds safe passage during migration periods by reducing light pollution, as well as building and glass collisions, through the Lights Out Oklahoma campaign, and

WHEREAS, birds help with the control of pests, carrion regulation, pollination, and seed dispersal while adding beauty and connecting people to nature and the outdoors; and

1 WHEREAS, birdwatching is an economic driver in the State of
2 Oklahoma and is a fun, relaxing, multigenerational, educational and
3 wellness activity for all; and

4 WHEREAS, a wide diversity of birds in Oklahoma indicates a
5 healthy environment; and

6 WHEREAS, Oklahoma is part of the central flyway through which
7 approximately 400 different species of birds migrate during the
8 spring and fall; and

9 WHEREAS, during peak migration hundreds of millions of birds
10 will come to pass through our state, including many long-distance
11 migrants like Mississippi kites and common nighthawks and endangered
12 species like whooping crane; and

13 WHEREAS, the Oklahoma state bird, the scissor-tailed flycatcher,
14 is one of the many species of birds that migrate to our state to
15 nest and rear their young; and

16 WHEREAS, most birds migrate at night, navigate by using the
17 stars and moon, and can become disoriented by bright artificial
18 light and sky glow, resulting in birds losing their way, exhaustion,
19 and deadly collisions with buildings, glass, power lines, and
20 vehicles; and

21 WHEREAS, collisions with buildings is one of the top causes of
22 mortality of birds in the United States; and

23 WHEREAS, the Lights Out Oklahoma program strategy is aimed to
24 persuade building owners, organization administrators, managers, and

1 homeowners to turn off exterior lighting on all buildings and
2 prevent interior lighting from shining out into the night during the
3 high migration intensity months of April, May, September, and
4 October; and

5 WHEREAS, these measures save energy and money and protect birds
6 migrating to nesting grounds in the spring and wintering grounds in
7 the fall; and

8 WHEREAS, Oklahoma joins the international community and states
9 including Texas, Colorado, Kansas, and Florida in sponsoring Lights
10 Out projects to protect birds during migration.

11 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
12 OF THE 2ND SESSION OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE, THE SENATE
13 CONCURRING THEREIN:

14 THAT the Oklahoma State Legislature supports reducing bird
15 mortality in the areas and encourages Oklahoma businesses, state
16 agencies, universities and schools, sports complexes, organizations,
17 and residents to turn off any exterior lighting and shield interior
18 lighting during the high migration intensity months of April, May,
19 September, and October.

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21 DIRECT TO CALENDAR.
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